



the basic
argument



allowable
evils

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

The reading for today is a powerful version of the argument that evil rules out the existence of God, which is due to the Australian 20th century philosopher John Mackie.



In its simplest form the problem is this : God is omnipotent ; God is wholly good ; and yet evil exists. There seems to be some contradiction between these three propositions, so that if any two of them were true the third would be false. But at the same time all three are essential parts of most theological positions : the theologian, it seems, at once *must* adhere and *cannot consistently* adhere to all three.

The basis of Mackie's argument comes in the following passage:

existence of God, which is due to the

The reading for today is a powerful version

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Australian 20th century philosopher John

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The basis of Mackie's argument comes in the

following passage:

So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



good, it always reminds

5. If something is wholly

as in every other case.



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is important, it

2: If something

cairibiriing about

any possible



the 1990s, the number of people with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems, and the importance of providing them with appropriate services. However, there is a significant gap between the current provision of services and the needs of the population. This gap is due to a number of factors, including a lack of resources, a lack of training for staff, and a lack of understanding of the needs of people with mental health problems. This paper will discuss the current provision of services and the needs of the population, and will propose a number of ways in which the gap can be closed.

The first way in which the gap can be closed is by increasing the resources available to mental health services. This can be done by increasing the number of staff, by increasing the number of services, and by increasing the funding available to mental health services. The second way in which the gap can be closed is by increasing the training of staff. This can be done by providing staff with training in the needs of people with mental health problems, and by providing staff with training in the use of new services.

The third way in which the gap can be closed is by increasing the understanding of the needs of people with mental health problems. This can be done by providing information to the public about mental health problems, and by providing information to staff about the needs of people with mental health problems. The fourth way in which the gap can be closed is by providing people with mental health problems with appropriate services. This can be done by providing people with mental health problems with a range of services, including counselling, medication, and social support.

There are a number of ways in which the gap can be closed, and it is important that all of these ways are pursued. This paper has discussed the current provision of services and the needs of the population, and has proposed a number of ways in which the gap can be closed. It is hoped that this paper will help to raise awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems, and will help to bring about the changes that are needed to close the gap.

2. The current provision of services and the needs of the population

The current provision of services for people with mental health problems is inadequate. There is a significant gap between the current provision of services and the needs of the population. This gap is due to a number of factors, including a lack of resources, a lack of training for staff, and a lack of understanding of the needs of people with mental health problems. This paper will discuss the current provision of services and the needs of the population, and will propose a number of ways in which the gap can be closed.

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1. If God exists, then God is

4. If God exists, then God is

(3,6)

prints even as it can.

it always initiates as much

3. If God exists, then God can

elinitatesas much printless

6. If God exists, then God

do anything. (1,2)

7. If God exists, then God

elinites all point less vii.

evil as God said. (4,5)



2. If something is on it,

no point less evi1. (7)

9*. Some principles exist.

5*. If something is wholly good,

it can do anything.

8. If God exists, then there is

C. God does not exist. (8,9)



wholly good.

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There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.



9*. Some points less

evivivis. exis. stis.

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